

Billy Leet

Product researcher who changes the question.

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Staff UX researcher with **8+ years across Google, Instagram, and Duolingo**. I lead ambiguous, high-stakes research from foundational framing through product direction, combining deep qualitative work, surveys, diary studies, and behavioral data. Former speech-language pathologist; trained to notice the gap between what people intend and what they can express.

my throughline ←

Generative research, mixed methods, and influence that helps teams rethink what they are building.

selected experience

Independent

Feb 2025–present

UX Research Consultant

- Led foundational qualitative research for Change.org on a small user segment driving outsized platform impact; designed the approach, conducted fieldwork, and delivered strategic direction to product leadership.

Duolingo

May 2021–Feb 2025

Sr UX Research Manager · Oct 2022 ← **Staff UX Researcher** · Jul 2022 ← **Senior UX Researcher**

- Led 10+ studies over eight months for Duolingo's learning-path redesign: foundational interviews, usability and concept testing, and diary research that steered the company's highest-priority product change.
- Created Rolling Research, a continuous-feedback program later scaled across product areas; pioneered AI-assisted meta-analysis to turn hundreds of learner interviews into durable strategic guidance.
- Managed and developed five researchers across Learning, Growth, and Monetization while remaining hands-on as a player-coach on critical initiatives.

Instagram

Jun 2018–May 2021

Senior UX Researcher · Feb 2021 ← **UXR II** · Sep 2020 ← **UXR I** · Sep 2019 ← **Associate UX Researcher**

- Owned foundational research on creators and public figures across Feed, Messenger, Profile, and Live, shaping product strategy during Instagram's shift toward a creator-first model.
- Led interviews, diary studies, concept tests, and large-scale surveys; a Live study with over 400 responses became a cross-functional workshop that generated 129 ideas for product planning.
- Built strategic understanding of creator safety, audience relationships, analytics, and monetization; concept testing informed a shipped safety feature.

Google

Apr 2016–May 2018

UX Research Coordinator, Google Cloud · Apr 2017 ← **Copyright Associate, YouTube**

- Supported study planning, recruiting, fieldwork, analysis, and research communication; advised teams on survey design and developer-focused research.

earlier chapter

Speech, language & communication · 2013–18

Clinical training across pediatric and adult communication—including aphasia, voice, and Deaf/Hard-of-Hearing settings—plus a private accent-coaching practice for multilingual professionals.

education

McGill University – M.Sc.A., Communication Sciences & Disorders

University of Pittsburgh — B.A., Linguistics & French

research toolkit

Strategy: foundational & generative research, product strategy, roadmap influence, research programs

Methods: in-depth interviews, usability & concept testing, diary & longitudinal studies, surveys, mixed methods

Leadership: executive communication, facilitation, mentoring, team development, player-coach leadership

Languages: English (native), French (full professional), ASL (professional working)